GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology

Accelerating Digital Transformation for a Smarter India

Confidential and Proprietory

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HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

SHRI ASHWINI VAISHNAW



HONORABLE MINISTER, MINISTRY OF ELECTRONICS AND INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

MESSAGE

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MESSAGE

India's digital transformation has emerged as one of the defining drivers of its economic growth, governance reforms, innovation ecosystem, and global competitiveness. The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) plays a pivotal role in shaping the nation's digital future by promoting electronics manufacturing, digital infrastructure, cybersecurity, emerging technologies, e-governance, and innovation-led entrepreneurship.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) remains committed to supporting the Ministry's vision of building a digitally empowered and technologically advanced India. Through policy advocacy, industry collaboration, startup facilitation, investment promotion, research partnerships, digital skill development, and innovation ecosystems, CCI India seeks to contribute towards strengthening India's leadership in the global digital economy.

This Knowledge Paper provides comprehensive insights into the Ministry's strategic priorities, policy framework, flagship initiatives, emerging technologies, investment opportunities, and collaborative avenues that can accelerate digital transformation. It highlights opportunities across artificial intelligence, semiconductor manufacturing, electronics design, cybersecurity, cloud computing, digital public infrastructure, Industry 4.0, and technology-driven entrepreneurship.

The publication is intended to serve as a valuable reference for policymakers, technology companies, startups, investors, research institutions, academia, industry leaders, and development organizations seeking to contribute to India's digital growth journey. By encouraging innovation, investment, and strategic partnerships, it aims to strengthen digital ecosystems, generate high-value employment, and promote sustainable technological advancement.

As India advances towards becoming a global digital powerhouse, collaboration between government, industry, academia, and innovators will remain essential. CCI India remains dedicated to partnering with the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology in building an inclusive, secure, and innovation-driven digital economy.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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PREFACE

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) stands at the fulcrum of India's most consequential national transformation. In an era where digital infrastructure is the new arterial road network, semiconductors are the new steel, and data is the new petroleum, MeitY's mandate transcends technology governance it constitutes the architecture of India's economic sovereignty and global competitiveness in the 21st century.

India's digital economy, valued at approximately USD 200 billion in 2024, is projected to scale to USD 1 trillion by 2028. This trajectory is not incidental. It is the product of deliberate, coordinated policy interventions from the Digital India Mission launched in 2015 to the India Semiconductor Mission of 2021, from UPI's global proliferation to the IndiaAI Mission of 2024. MeitY's institutional fingerprints are embedded across each of these milestones, reflecting a ministry that has evolved from a regulatory body into a strategic catalyst for national development.

This Knowledge Paper has been prepared by CCI India the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India to present a rigorous, evidence-based strategic analysis of the Ministry's mandate, institutional architecture, policy priorities, and ecosystem gaps. It positions CCI India as a credible, networked, and execution-capable partner that can bridge the final mile between policy ambition and on-ground delivery.

The Paper is aligned with the Government of India's overarching vision of Viksit Bharat 2047 a Developed India by the centenary of Independence. Achieving that vision demands that digital and electronic ecosystems be deepened, democratised, and globally integrated. CCI India's role in this journey as knowledge partner, investment facilitator, industry-government bridge, and startup enabler is precisely what this document articulates.

This paper is intended for Union Ministers, Secretaries to Government of India, senior officers of NITI Aayog and MeitY, industry leaders, investors, development finance institutions, and international development agencies.

Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

1.Introduction to the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Constitutional and Statutory Mandate

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) derives its authority from Entry 31 of the Union List of the Seventh Schedule to the Constitution of India, which grants the Union Parliament exclusive legislative competence over 'Posts and telegraphs; telephones, wireless, broadcasting and other like forms of communication.' This constitutional anchor, supplemented by landmark legislation including the Information Technology Act, 2000 (as amended in 2008), the Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, and the National Policy on Electronics 2019, defines MeitY's mandate as the sovereign authority over India's digital and electronic infrastructure.

MeitY's statutory mandate encompasses four core functions: (a) IT and e-governance policy formulation and legislative oversight; (b) electronics hardware manufacturing promotion and R&D; (c) cybersecurity governance and digital trust infrastructure; and (d) promotion of emerging technologies including AI, blockchain, quantum computing, and semiconductor design. The Ministry also regulates the IT sector under the IT Act's provisions related to electronic records, digital signatures, and data localisation.

Institutional Evolution

MeitY's evolution mirrors India's own digital transformation journey. The Department of Electronics, established in 1970 under the visionary leadership of the late Dr. Vikram Sarabhai's contemporaries, was India's first institutional response to the coming age of information technology. It merged with the nascent IT department to form the Department of Information Technology (DIT) in 2000, the very year that the landmark IT Act was passed. In 2012, DIT was renamed the Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY), reflecting the growing convergence between hardware manufacturing and software services. The reconstitution as MeitY in 2017, with full Ministry status, signalled the government's recognition that digital governance required Cabinet-level strategic leadership.

This evolution has not been merely administrative. Each institutional transition was accompanied by substantive policy shifts from import substitution in electronics to export-oriented software services growth; from basic e-governance to sophisticated digital public infrastructure; from IT industry facilitation to emerging technology sovereignty. MeitY today is an institution with a 54-year institutional memory and a forward-looking mandate to make India a USD 1 trillion digital economy.

Governance Architecture

MeitY exercises governance authority through a layered institutional architecture. At the apex is the Cabinet Minister (currently Shri Ashwini Vaishnaw, who additionally holds the Communications and Railways portfolios), supported by a Minister of State. The administrative machinery is headed by the Secretary (MeitY), supported by Additional Secretaries and Joint Secretaries overseeing distinct functional divisions. Key divisions include: Electronics and Semiconductor Division; IT and e-Governance Division; Cybersecurity Division; Emerging Technologies Division; Digital Payments Division; and the Data Governance Division. This structure ensures specialised policy attention across the Ministry's full mandate.

National Significance

MeitY's national significance can be assessed across three dimensions. Economically, the IT-electronics ecosystem contributes approximately 10-12% to GDP and constitutes over 15% of India's total exports. Strategically, digital sovereignty , control over data infrastructure, semiconductor supply chains, and AI platforms is increasingly recognised as a national security imperative. Socially, the Ministry's digital inclusion agenda has extended banking, healthcare, education, and government services to hundreds of millions of previously underserved citizens. MeitY is not merely a technology ministry; it is an institution that shapes the quality and conditions of citizenship in the digital age.

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2.Historical Timeline of the Ministry

The following timeline captures the major institutional milestones, policy reforms, and programmatic achievements that have shaped MeitY's evolution over five decades:

Year	Milestone / Reform	Strategic Significance
1970	Department of Electronics established under Union Government	India's first institutional response to the emerging global electronics era; set foundation for domestic hardware policy.
1984	Computer Policy announced; IBM's exit leads to HCL, Wipro entry	Catalysed domestic IT industry growth; created conditions for India's software services boom.
1986	Software Export Policy; Software Technology Parks concept introduced	Launched India's IT export engine; STPs became the incubators of the USD 250 billion IT-BPM industry.
1991	Liberalisation; IT sector declared 'industry' for policy purposes	Aligned IT sector with broader economic reforms; unleashed private investment and FDI.
1998	National Task Force on IT and Software Development; Millennium Report	Strategic vision for making India a global IT superpower; set 10-year targets for software exports.
2000	IT Act, 2000 enacted; DIT formed; Y2K opportunity maximised	Legal framework for digital transactions established; India's IT credibility on global stage secured.
2006	National e-Governance Plan (NeGP) launched	Structured framework for 27 Mission Mode Projects; first comprehensive e-governance architecture.
2012	DIT renamed DeitY; National Policy on Electronics (NPE) 2012	Recognition of hardware-software convergence; first coordinated electronics manufacturing policy.
2015	Digital India Programme launched by PM Modi; BharatNet initiated	Transformational mission across digital infrastructure, digital services, and digital literacy.
2017	DeitY elevated to MeitY full Ministry status	Cabinet-level recognition of digital governance importance; expanded mandate and institutional capacity.
2018	Pradhan Mantri Gramin Digital Saksharta Abhiyan (PMGDISHA) launched	Largest digital literacy programme globally; 6 crore rural citizens trained.
2019	National Policy on Electronics (NPE) 2019; PLI Scheme for electronics	Ambitious USD 400 billion electronics manufacturing target by 2025; attracted global OEM investment.
2021	India Semiconductor Mission (ISM); PLI for IT Hardware	Strategic response to global chip shortage; positioned India as semiconductor hub.
2022	Digital Personal Data Protection Act (draft); Semicon India programme	Data sovereignty framework; USD 10 billion incentive ecosystem for chip manufacturing.
2023	Digital Personal Data Protection Act enacted; IndiaAI Mission conceptualised	Landmark data governance legislation; foundational AI policy framework.
2024	IndiaAI Mission approved at USD 1.25 billion; BharatGen initiative	Largest government AI compute investment; indigenous LLM development initiated.
2025–26	Semiconductor fabs under construction; AI Centres of Excellence operational	India's entry into advanced manufacturing; domestic AI R&D ecosystem taking shape.